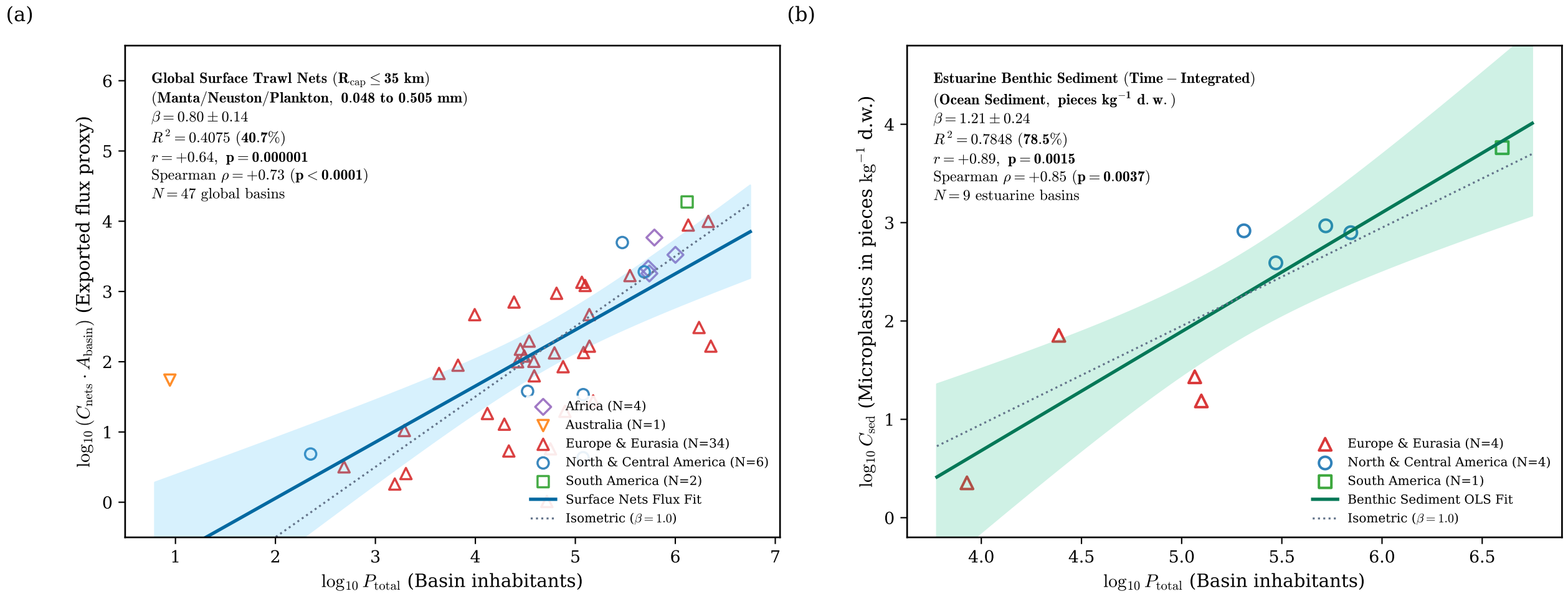

(a)
Global Surface Trawl Nets ($\mathbf{R_{cap} \leq 35}$ km)
(Manta/Neuston/Plankton, 0.048 to 0.505 mm)
$\beta = 0.80 \pm 0.14$
$R^2 = 0.4075$ (40.7%)
$r = +0.64$, $\mathbf{p = 0.000001}$
Spearman $\rho = +0.73$ ($\mathbf{p < 0.0001}$)
$N = 47$ global basins
Africa (N=4)
Australia (N=1)
Europe & Eurasia (N=34)
North & Central America (N=6)
South America (N=2)
Surface Nets Flux Fit
Isometric ($\beta = 1.0$)
$\log_{10}(C_{nets} \cdot A_{basin})$ (Exported flux proxy)
$\log_{10} P_{total}$ (Basin inhabitants)
(b)
Estuarine Benthic Sediment (Time – Integrated)
(Ocean Sediment, pieces kg^{-1} d. w.)
$\beta = 1.21 \pm 0.24$
$R^2 = 0.7848$ (78.5%)
$r = +0.89$, $\mathbf{p = 0.0015}$
Spearman $\rho = +0.85$ ($\mathbf{p = 0.0037}$)
$N = 9$ estuarine basins
Europe & Eurasia (N=4)
North & Central America (N=4)
South America (N=1)
Benthic Sediment OLS Fit
Isometric ($\beta = 1.0$)
$\log_{10} C_{sed}$ (Microplastics in pieces kg^{-1} d.w.)
$\log_{10} P_{total}$ (Basin inhabitants)